

Palak Maheshwari

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SUMMARY

I am a passionate freshman in college with an interest in biotechnology, including genetic engineering, gene expression, and CRISPR-Cas9 gene editing. I want to explore the realm of cancer genetics to create novel treatments and therapies for cancer. Flexible, always ready for a challenge, and always moving forward.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

CrisprBits Pvt Limited

May 2024 – June 2024

Research Intern

- Conducted preliminary research for a one-pot genetic test for Beta Thalassemia in the Indian population using CRISPR-Cas12b.
- Gained proficiency in databases such as NCBI and tools like SnapGene.
- Learned core biotechnology techniques including primer and guide RNA design, PCR, gel electrophoresis, DNA sequencing, and CRISPR-Cas12b-based gene editing.
- Attended seminars on lab safety, research methodology, and academic integrity.

India Institute of Head & Neck Oncology, Indore

August 2023 – January 2024

Shadowing Intern

- Observed various cancer treatments including Chemotherapy, Radiation Therapy, and Low-Level Laser Therapy.
- Attended seminars on palliative care in cancer treatments led by leading doctors.
- Interacted with 30+ cancer patients and their families to better understand patient care and support.
- Gained insight into oncology practices and the multidisciplinary approach to cancer treatment.

OTHER EXPERIENCE

ASSET Genwise Residential Summer Program

May 2025 – June 2025

Residential Counselor

- Supervised and supported over 180 gifted students in a residential camp setting.
- Created and facilitated engaging activities after academic sessions, including sports, debate, and arts and crafts.
- Monitored students' physical, mental, and emotional well-being during their time at camp.

EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego

Expected Graduation June 2029

B.S. Molecular and Cell Biology

San Diego, CA

- GPA:** 4.00
- Relevant Coursework:**
 - BILD 4 A+
 - BICD 100 A

The Shishukunj International School, Indore

Graduated June 2025

High School

Indore, MP, India

SKILLS

- Technical:** Python, Java, SnapGene, Microsoft Office Suite, Google Suite, Canva
- Languages:** English (Proficient), Hindi (Proficient in Speaking), French (Beginner)

AWARDS & EXTRACURRICULARS

- NMSC Finalist, 2024-25
- National Rank 92 in NSTSE 2023 (India)
- Part of Student Council as Secretary of Student Welfare at The Shishukunj International School
- Leader of the Social Outreach and Welfare Organization, led by the Shishukunj International School
- Mentor and Leader of the Brain Lab: The Innovation Club at The Shishukunj International School